

Clermont County Township Association Meeting

Date: 02/20/2025

Host: Pierce Township

Meeting was called to order: Meeting called to order by Bob Hausermann at 6:20 PM with the following CCTA Officers & Active Members in attendance:

Franklin Township:

Trustee Terry Wilson

Goshen Township:

Trustee / CCTA President Bob Hausermann

Ohio Township:

Trustees Rick Hinson, Keith Vogelsang

Pierce Township:

Trustee / CCTA Vice President Allen Freeman, Fiscal Officer Debbie Schwey

Union Township:

Trustee John Becker

Washington Township:

Trustee Dennis Cooper

Williamsburg Township:

Trustees Bari Henning, Gary Jordan, Guy Bainum

And CCTA Secretary/Treasurer Shelby Baird

A thank you was offered by Allen Freeman to Pierce Township was offered for hosting this evening's meeting and dinner, and specifically to Debbie Schwey, for the work putting everything together. A prayer was offered by Guy Bainum, and members recited the Pledge of Allegiance, and attendees proceeded to dinner at 6:24 PM.

Opening remarks: At approximately 6:45 PM Bob Hauserman resumed the meeting by inviting the guest speaker, Mr. Shrive, to take the floor for his presentation.

Guest Speaker: Brian Shrive, of the Clermont County Prosecutor's office made a presentation introducing the upcoming changes to zoning code enforcement which become effective April 3rd, 2025. These changes come from the passage of HB 315. Some Q&A discussion between CCTA members and Mr. Shrive followed, with the conclusion of his presentation at 7:03 PM.

CCTA Business: At the conclusion of Mr. Shrive's presentation, Mr. Freeman took the floor. Mr. Freeman had some pending legislative updates he wanted to share with the CCTA. Mr. Freeman shared information and thoughts related to rising concerns on the elimination of property taxes and the potential impact to township revenues.

Mr. Freeman raised that he feels the CCTA should think about having an extra meeting in April. He feels it's important that we can meet again and perhaps have someone from OTA come to give us a briefing on

the 9 bills working their way through the general assembly. He would also hope that perhaps Reps Schmidt and Byrd could also come to that meeting, as well as Sen Johnson.

Discussion ensued about the topics and more detail about the budget bill, and other legislation. He shared some reminders about marijuana legalization, and the new bill that is circulating to eliminate the community host revenues that were part of the original ballot initiative, along with more detail about the requirements of approving dispensaries.

Mr. Freeman shared his experience with a small township up north that is very small, and the challenges they've had due to revenue when it came to an imperative need to replace their fire engine due to a catastrophic failure.

Discussion continued around HB 96 and its companion bill in the senate. Mr. Hausermann shared some thoughts around activities in Goshen township about their decision-making process they undertook about where and how to allow dispensaries.

Mr. Cooper shared that he felt it was important to schedule the meeting very soon to allow time to coordinate the guests and ensure they will be there. He feels it's important to have them all in the same room at the same time to ask them questions, instead of having fractured conversations with "he said/she said" issues.

Mr. Freeman and Mr. Hausermann also discussed the thought and practicality of the CCTA sending a delegation to the General Assembly to speak at the relative committees. Discussions around revenue and legislation.

Mr. Freeman then brought the conversation back to the earlier question of having a meeting in April. Options of either having a local meeting or going to the state legislature to knock on doors were discussed. Mr. Hausermann asked for a show of hands of who wants to have an April meeting, and organize it. Mr. Freeman clarified that he felt that in lieu of a meeting we would go to lobby in the offices at the state legislature.

A member pointed out that it's obvious something needs to be done but noted that when asked no one raised their hands about having a meeting. Mr. Hausermann asked again if the CCTA as an organization do we want to take on the project. Another member noted that if we had a meeting locally instead it would likely be better attended.

Mr. Freeman said that we could try to make some calls to see who is available, and which way, and look toward the March meeting. Mr. Hausermann commented that the March meeting is with the Board of Health, and Mr. Cooper added that we only have a 15-minute window to do our business. Mr. Freeman agreed that the March meeting is not good.

Mr. Hausermann stated that the option was to either have a special meeting in April or not at all. Mr. Freeman agreed and said his recommendation is that we could have the special meeting in April and still try to storm the hill up at the House if we wanted. Dates were discussed and Mr. Hausermann asked if the third Thursday as usual would be good for everyone.

Mr. Freeman said that if we wanted to do both he would try to coordinate and set something up for a trip to Columbus and additionally try to get someone from the OTA to come to a meeting in April and get the state reps to come also.

Mr. Hausermann said to get in touch and confirm that we can get everyone to come, and Mr. Freeman agreed that he would. And we would discuss at the March meeting to coordinate the best date in April. He asked the group for clarity if they are ok with not sticking to the regular meeting night of the third Thursday. Mr. Vogelsang asked that in the interest of clarification the special meeting would be to discuss the marijuana legislation and concerns about reductions to township revenues. Mr. Freeman said yes, and that we'd also look to discuss the moves to eliminate property taxes and ask questions about how the legislature is looking to address these issues.

Mr. Freeman also shared that there have been some changes to the TIF laws, and we may want to discuss those changes as well. He provided some of his thoughts on those changes. He concluded with a recap of his tasks related to coordinating the April special meeting.

Mr. Hausermann reminded the group the next meeting in March will be at the County Engineer's office with the Board of Health. Mr. Cooper shared that everyone will be getting a letter from the Board of Health with the meeting reminder.

Mr. Hausermann reminded the group that we just needed to wrap up a little more business and asked Mr. Baird to review the Treasurer's report.

Mr. Baird reviewed the Treasurer's report, detailing that the one outstanding check to Goshen Shop-With-A-Cop donation had cleared. Mr. Hausermann called for a vote to approve the report. Mr. Cooper moved to approve the report, with Mr. Bainum seconding the motion. Mr. Hausermann called for a vote on the motion. Motion carried without opposition.

Mr. Baird moved to review the minutes of the January 16, 2025, meeting. Mr. Baird informed those members present that he had emailed the membership the draft of the minutes and asked if they had been reviewed and called for any questions, omissions, or corrections.

Mr. Hausermann stated that he believed everyone had been emailed the minutes, and had an opportunity so asked for a motion to approve the minutes. A member moved to accept the minutes as given and Mr. Hausermann seconded. Motion carried without opposition.

Mr. Hausermann asked if anyone else has any business to come forward this evening. There was none.

Mr. Cooper made a motion to adjourn. Mr. Baird announced he'd been in contact with Jessica at the Board of Health and passed along that the meeting of the District Advisory Council is set for 7:15 pm. Reminding everyone that the meeting will be the 20th of March at the engineer's office on Bauer Rd. Mr. Hausermann asked if our normal meeting will be at the usual time. Mr. Baird said yes they are still expecting to start arriving around 6pm.

Mr. Cooper again moved that the meeting be adjourned. Motion was seconded by Mr. Hausermann. Meeting adjourned at 7:41 PM.